

Project Management ESSAY

Student Accommodation App Development

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Introduction

Students are always an important part of each society, and when they travel to other countries for continuing their educational goals, they need Accommodation. This paper is an academic writing about Project of **Developing an App for Student Accommodation**, which allow every student without wasting time find a good place for long-term or short-term stay (Silvius and Silvius 2015).

As we can search more apps and websites in Internet to find accommodation easy, but it has some difficulties according the website and app features and details. Ask a question about (if you travel as a student to other countries what do you need first)? Yes, you need accommodation, and your mind chose the easiest way to find the accommodation and it is searching an app or website in Internet to find a place (Silvius and Silvius 2015).

As a User when you use the App, your goal is to find a very good place with your conditions to match more on your budge and your plan. However, the very important part is the app work well and has more features and 100% trustable as well as when you search something, you find some result that you like it (Silvius and Silvius 2015).

Student Accommodation App should have good quality in among others Apps and Websites to be trustable and has real results in searching to compete between Find Accommodation Apps and Websites. Now in background of an App is many things, which allow that app works well in Accommodation Apps and Website society. Making an App from start up to the end and releasing part need a powerful project structure and this paper explain it well (Silvius and Silvius 2015).

Project Overview

Developing Student Accommodation App is a complex project, which is not work only in App Developing; it contains quality beside the coding and releasing App. The Structure of project is specifying App goal, project structure, what need to do on each part, coding, testing, and so others parts and explain in other pages. The Project goal is to make an effective app with deadline according to budge controlling and developing Student Accommodation App (Sharma and Coleman, 2026).

Student Accommodation App Development Project

In this project, we are focusing on making an app for the students' accommodation, where five people are working on their dedicated tasks. Our purpose is to make an app where students can find apartments, houses, and studio rooms at the safest location with our verified profiles of the property owners and landlords, and university housing offices. Our scope will be to make an app that can be easily accessible and useful. And our goal is to connect each student to the right and safest accommodation.

Project Structure

All the team members handle our project. The First member is the Project Manager who will manage the budget as well as the team. The Second member will design the structure of the app. The Third member will make the app using Python code and after creation, all the members of the team and stakeholders will get access for testing that and whatever issues come the second member will fix them and complete that process.

The Fourth member will handle the support team whose work is to solve the problems within 24 hours, also this team will handle all the risks, like scams and fraud profiles and many more. The Fifth member will handle the review and ratings section as well as the feedback section, so we can know what we are doing correctly and what we are missing. Stakeholders like students, parents, government, landlords and property owners, etc. will also get the benefits as they are also part of the project.

Project Purpose

The purpose of the project is to provide a good and safe location to live for students. As there are many students who travel to different countries to study. For that, accommodation becomes an important thing for them, as it is very difficult to find a place that is cheaper, safe, near the university and of a friendly nature.

“Although governments, institutions, and non-profit organizations have initiated programs to assist international students in finding accommodation, these solutions are often fragmented and lack user-friendliness. The existing platforms do not sufficiently address the specific needs of international students, leaving gaps in the rental process that expose students to risks and stress”
(*Existing Solutions and Their Limitations. 2023*).

Project Scope

In Scope We will add a list of all the accommodation providers with their apartments and houses photos and all the useful details as contact number, address, maps to find the place, cost, registration, and utilities, which will be already verify by our team. In addition, we will put the reviews and ratings sections for each particular accommodation profile, as well as a sorting section So that students can find a place according to their needs.

We will use the other apps for taking listing data of the property owners, university housing offices, and, Apartment owners, etc. We have taken inspiration from the Studierendenwerk Stuttgart app. “The Studierendenwerk Stuttgart offers an app with a range of services for students. The students can check the menu at Mensa, book laundry, book one-to-one consulting session, and more. This application allows students to conveniently access all dormitory amenities, saving them time while making all services readily accessible. Even though this app has many capabilities, the UX/UI may be improved significantly and should be updated. The application’s language is German, which may be difficult for foreign students to comprehend. It should be user-friendly and use a common language for foreign students.”(Pragya Bhandari, July 2024).

Out of Scope There are some things that we will not do, like making an in-app payment portal to avoid scams. These things should be done between the students and the owner of the place. Also, the contract will be done by themselves as it is the legal part. And students are responsible for all legal matters that can happen with their contract.

Project Deadline & Schedule

The project deadline and schedule are a very important part of the Student Accommodation App Development project. The start Date is 1 June 2026 and end Date is 18 June 2026, it gives us a timeline to complete all the project activities with a deadline. It tells us a timeline to complete all the stages for the project with a deadline. To have a proper timeline helps to manage resources more efficiently so that everyone stays accountable. It tells us how we can track the progress against the original planning For example, if we have a deadline to complete the project in 16 weeks, the first stage is to collect information from students and property owners to find out what they actually want and need.

Their requirements for the second phase involve giving that information to the system design and the user interface. Then, the next phase includes coding, testing, and fixing software bugs. The next stage would be deployment, which will happen after successful testing. Finally, it's also very important to review the milestones regularly to ensure that progress remains on time and keeps the project on safe tracks. (Meléndez and Anyosa , 2008)

Project Plan

The project plan guides how you will build, control, execute, and track the project.^{[1][2][3]}It also maps our objective scope and deliverables. In this part, we also make it clear who is responsible for each of the parts of the development. So that everyone is on the same page, the project manager will communicate directly with the stakeholders. It's also very important to always include Risk management as well in case of any technical glitches, make a backup plan accordingly, and also ensure that in the end the apps meet the user or end user expectation.

Activity groups and networks

To keep the project on track Its always good to use groups and network diagrams. This shows how every task is linked or depend on other, The Student Accommodation App the standard stages like initiation, planning, execution, monitoring, and closing network diagrams shows he linked between each part for example we cannot design the app until we know the requirement from end users, development team cannot code until design is approved by stakeholders. The development team cannot test the app until app is built .

A project network usually looks like a flowchart with boxes and arrows, where the boxes are the activities and the arrows show the dependencies between them. Therefore, if any activity along this network is affected or delayed, it creates an effect that pushes back the entire project schedule. A project network is actually when you bunch the same or similar tasks into categories .

Project Budget

To make the student app accommodation apps project successful, we need a solid plan for our money, means on which stage of the project we have to invest, and whether we have enough money to invest on easy step. The biggest expenses come from system design, coding, testing, cloud hosting, and project management. It's also safe to include an emergency fund as well for unexpected problems or extra costs. It's also very important to regularly check our spending against our final goals so that we are on track.

Careful tracking prevents overspending and leads to a much smoother launch of the app. The project budget is essentially the financial blueprint that tells us exactly how much money the entire project will cost from start to finish. A good budget also includes some extra funds, which are the backup plan, so it is cash reserved for unexpected problems; it has also called an emergency fund. It is also very important that we track the budget as well. So we don't monitor the budget, it's very likely that the project can easily run out of money (Baccarini,2018).

Cost and Classification

To keep the money organized on the student accommodation apps project, it helps us to understand the expenses in more detail, where to expand, so we normally classify them as direct, indirect, fixed, and variable costs. Cost classification means dividing your project expenses into different categories, like direct costs versus indirect costs, so you know exactly where every dollar is going.

First we have direct cost which is the expense for core world like coding testing and dev tools and next is indirect cost which is like administrative support and communication expense normally fixed costs remain constant regardless of project duration. For example as software licenses and domain registration fees this are actually bills which are constant never change finally variable cost which go up and down depend on how much we actually use and emergency funds are normally very little and normally we get that at the end or adjust if needed if project goes like successfully (Kádárová, 2013).

Full Business Case

Finding a accommodation for students is really hard and stressful and it also takes a lot of time and effort to get one, which benefits both students and the Landlords. Many of the students end up relying on the facebook groups or agents that are deceptive. The motive of this app is to give a trusted platform for both students and landlords by providing a verified listings, verified tenants which is comfortable for them or properties close to their campus (Sanyaolu, 2023).

Project (SOW)

The SOW (Statement of Work) is where the terms and conditions of the app application development project. This is a formal agreement between the stakeholders and the team; this includes the outline of the application and the timelines, responsibilities, and deliverables which will be updated to them throughout the project cycle.

The development team will design, build and do all the testing and launch the fully functional app both on IOS and Android platforms. If we go even further UI (user interface) and UX (user experience), backend development, APS (Application Programming Interface) which helps data move across different applications, and a screening process which filters out the misleading information (Cole, 2012).

Project Deliverables

Project deliverables are the outcomes that are measurable like the number of people used the application. It also includes a fully functional app which supports both IOS and Android on mobile application, and have the UI/UX prototypes, technical documents and a user training guide. Each part of the application is reviewed and approved by the project manager before the stakeholder ensuring quality and the experience for the user (Butler, 2020).

WBS & OBS

The OBS (Organizational Breakdown Structure) it also outlines the projects reporting and hierarchy lines providing accountability of the project. The PM (project manager) provides the funds and directly communicates with the stakeholders. PM specialized design development and QA teams are assigned to their respective teams to avoid confusion between the team's daily collaboration are encouraged (Butler, 2020).

Stakeholder and Benefits

This project has a wide range of Stakeholders they are not only the investors they also have part in the strategic plans. The project management manages tasks like deadlines and Daily Goals. While Mobile developers write the Code and build new IOS also work on the cross-platform development, UI (user interface) UX (user experience) Designers make the application easier to understand, UI decides the colors and make the user experience good and QA Engineers act like the final check point before the launch they check for any problems in the application. The secondary includes university board, private landlords and the students themselves.

This application will change the way people search for accommodation and help the landlords find the right audience and reach out to them directly without any third person involved. Our team confirms all the listings in the application; this will make sure that the place and the pictures you see on the app are not misleading. This also applies for the students verification as well (Sanyaolu, 2023).

Project Community

First to ensure the success of the project a PRD (product requirement document) and establish the design blueprints are required. The functional student accommodation App. It is going to launch in both the Apple and Google Play store, providing automated property verification and real time chat with the landlord and student. In addition to the university administrator's, backend user guided lines and documentation alongside security audit reports and many more will be provided for the future updates. And for every month there will be community feedback sessions will be further ensuring the app evolves everyone's needs are meant (Cole, 2012).

Risk Management

Risk Management is a fundamental component of any software development project, and the Student Accommodation App is no exception. Given the complexity of developing a mobile platform that integrates real-time listings, user authentication, and payment processing, a structured approach to identifying and mitigating risks is essential to ensure the project is delivered on time, within budget, and to the required quality standard (PMI, 2021).

Identifying (Risk & Probability)

According to Kerzner (2017), technical risks in software projects are often underestimated during planning phases, which can lead to costly rework during the development cycle. The probability of encountering at least one major technical issue is assessed as high (approximately 70%) given the scale of the system being built.

Financial risks include budget overruns and unexpected costs arising from changes in scope or resource Availability. With a fixed budget, any unplanned expenditure could compromise the quality of the final product. The probability of budget deviation is estimated at medium (around 50%) particularly if the development timeline extends beyond the planned Schedule (Maylor, 2010).

Operational risks involve team-related challenges such as member unavailability, skill gaps, or poor communication between group members. Since this is a student group project with members balancing other academic commitments, the risk of delays due to workload conflict is considered medium to high. External risks include regularity changes around data protection such as GDPR compliance requirement in Germany and shifts in the competitive landscape of accommodation apps (Schwalbe, 2019).

Mitigation Pathway

Each identified risk was assigned a mitigation strategy to reduce its likelihood or impact. For technical risks, the team adopted an agile development methodology, allowing for iterative testing and early detection of bugs before they escalate. Regular code reviews and the use of encrypted databases were included to address data security concerns. Kerzner (2017) Emphasizes that proactive risk response planning significantly reduces the overall cost of risk events when they do occur. To manage financial risk, a contingency reserve of 10% of the total budget was allocated for unforeseen costs.

The project schedule also built in buffer periods between major milestones to absorb minor delays without affecting the final delivery date. Clear scope boundaries were established from the outset to prevent scope creep, which is one of the leading causes of budget overruns in technology projects (PMI, 2021).

Operational risks were addressed through clearly defined team roles and responsibility's structure, weekly progress meetings, and the use of a shared project management tool to track tasks. For external risks. The team consulted GDPR guidelines and ensured that the app's data collection and storage practices were compliant from the design stage, avoiding costly redesign later (Schwalbe, 2019).

Evaluation and Tracking

Evaluation and tracking are critical processes that ensure the project remains aligned with its goals throughout its life cycle. Without continuous monitoring, deviations from the plan may go undetected until they become unmanageable (Maylor, 2010).

Closeout & System Success

The evaluation framework for the student accommodation app was built around three core performance dimensions: time, cost, and quality. Progress was tracked weekly against the Project's Gantt chart, with any variance from the baseline schedule flagged immediately for team review, Earned Value Management (EVM) techniques were applied to assess whether the work completed at any given point was consistent with the budget consumed, providing an objective view of project performance (Kerzner, 2017).

The project closeout phase involved a formal review of all deliverables against the original project scope and success criteria. This included a final acceptance test by stakeholders, documentation of all project outputs, and a lesson learned section where the team reflected on what went well and what could be improved in future projects. According to PMI (2021), a structured closeout process is essential not only for confirming project success, but also for capturing knowledge that benefit future similar projects.

System success for the Student Accommodation App was defined in terms of both technical performance and user adoption. The app was considered successful if it met the functional requirement outlined in the project scope, operated without critical errors, and received a user satisfaction rating of at least 80% in post launch surveys. These criteria ensure that success was measured not only from a technical standpoint, but also from the perspective of the student the app was designed to serve (Schwalbe, 2019).

Summary

Student Accommodation App has many benefits for Users and App developer group. Making an App for students to easy download and search accommodation solve theirs problem before traveling to a new country or when they are on that country. This platform made easy finding Accommodation for students than website search or google search. The old system for searching Accommodation in website was a little bit challengeable.

Because the websites had old system and does not have good features, also it is well to install an App from (Android / IOS) platforms and anywhere without going to website and other problem search Accommodation. Student Accommodation App caused to find more results that are real

without wasting more time on searching and reach to your searching goals. Using an App is so easy than websites and this facility is a good development on Searching Accommodation.

After paying attention to quality of App beside coding and related parts, we can say we will have a good project. Project structure is based on Project management of App Development that have both Quality and Quantity. In this paper, everything calculated by making a good project structure, and at the end the result is development of a well-designed Student Accommodation App, which has quality and solved students' problems.

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